

The Words and Statements I Grew Up With
Part of the **Growing up: Teen years, 15. Collection**
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The words and statements I grew up with.
The words and statement that tried to define my reasons for success

I get great grades in math and science.
“It’s because you are the daughter of STEM parents”
I do well on a project
“It’s because they helped you on this and that”
I gain an opportunity or achieve an achievement
“It’s because they supported you”
I say that I am the one who accomplished things, not them
“You should be grateful, you should be thankful”
I talk about my family
“You are so lucky, I wish I had a family like yours”
I get prizes and great scores
“You are just like your parents”
I get to a certain point
“It’s because they gave you this and that that you got here”

...

But..
It was me who did all the work,
I was the one who made the effort that seems to be theirs,
I was the one who took the test,
I was the one with the idea that got overridden by theirs,
I was the one who was the good student, the good listener in class
Not them.
It was I, it was
Me, me, me
Not you, not them, me.
So why do they seem to get all the credit for all the achievements I do, and yet I get
credit for all the negatives?

They say, “Well, it’s the burden of the First Borns”, “Well, you are the first born daughter
after all, you influence the way your younger cousins and siblings act”, “You influenced
them to act this way”

They say, "Don't be like her, she's wrong", "Don't act like you know everything", "Well, we gave you this but never this so you are the one who is wrong", "You brought this upon yourself"

Oh, the words I grew up with that haunted me and surrounded me.

The never ending list of criticisms aimed at me, the so called 'advice', the so called 'empathy'.

Can't even be angry because that would add to my seemingly never ending list of faults.

Oh, the words that surrounded me growing up

Now in the past

Now I surround myself with positivity as I take my step toward the light holding hands with God as he leads the way.